Project Proposal Template · Expert version

A project proposal template helps you win approval for a project by setting out the problem, your proposed solution, the objectives, scope, timeline, budget and risks in a clear, persuasive structure.

How to use this template

1. Define the problem with evidence before proposing a solution.
2. Describe the solution, objectives and scope, including exclusions.
3. Fill in the Budget & timeline tab; contingency and total calculate automatically.
4. State benefits and risks honestly.
5. Write a one-paragraph summary and a clear ask, then share for approval.

Tips

- Lead with the decision-maker's priorities.
- Quantify benefits wherever possible.
- Keep it short; attach detail as appendices.
- Turn an approved proposal into a project charter.

Proposal · Write the summary last

Section	What to write	Your content
Title and summary	One paragraph: the problem, your solution and the ask.	
Background / problem	What is wrong today and the evidence.	
Proposed solution	What you will do and why this approach.	
Objectives	Measurable outcomes (SMART).	
Scope	In scope and out of scope.	
Deliverables	What will be produced.	
Approach and timeline	Phases and key milestones (see Budget & timeline tab).	
Budget	Total cost and main cost lines.	
Benefits	Financial and non-financial benefits; ROI if known.	
Risks	Top risks and how you will manage them.	
Team	Who will deliver and their roles.	
Next steps / approval	Decision needed, by whom and by when.	

Budget & timeline · Phases, dates and costs

Phase / item	Start	End	Cost ($)	Notes
Discovery	1 Apr 2026	15 Apr 2026	8,000	
Design	16 Apr 2026	8 May 2026	15,000	
Build	11 May 2026	3 Jul 2026	60,000	
Launch and training	6 Jul 2026	17 Jul 2026	7,000	
Contingency (10%)			9,000	
Total			99,000	